Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU) Agritech Portal
Crop Protection :: Cereals :: Maize Diseases :: Common Rust
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Crop: Maize (Zea mays)
Disease: Common Rust
Causal Organism: Puccinia sorghi Schw.

Symptoms:
Minute flecks appear on both sides of leaves. Circular to elongate cinnamon brown, powdery, erumpent pustules appear on both leaf surfaces. As the crop matures, brownish black pustules develop. In severe cases, infection spreads to sheath and other plant parts.

Pathogen and Mode of Spread:
Puccinia sorghi is a heterocious rust. Uredospores are single celled, echinulate, yellowish brown, pedicellate, elliptical. Teliospores are reddish brown, two celled, rounded at apex.
Alternate hosts: Oxalis corniculata, Oxalis stricta.
Primary spread through alternate hosts. Secondary spread through wind borne uredospores.
Favourable conditions: Cool, warm and moist weather (15 - 25 °C).

Management & Chemical Control:
1. Cultural Management: Remove alternate hosts (Oxalis spp.). Collect remains of infected crop and destroy by burning or deep burial.
2. Chemical Control (Foliar Sprays):
   - Foliar spray of Mancozeb @ 2 g/l (or 2 kg/ha in 1000 litres of water) at 35 and 50 days after sowing (DAS).
   - Alternatively, spray Chlorothalonil @ 2 g/l at 35 and 50 DAS.
   - Alternatively, spray Tebuconazole @ 1 ml/l or Kresoxim-methyl 44.3% SC @ 1 ml/l at 35 and 50 DAS.